#2024election: An Exploratory Analysis of Partisan Entertainment on TikTok

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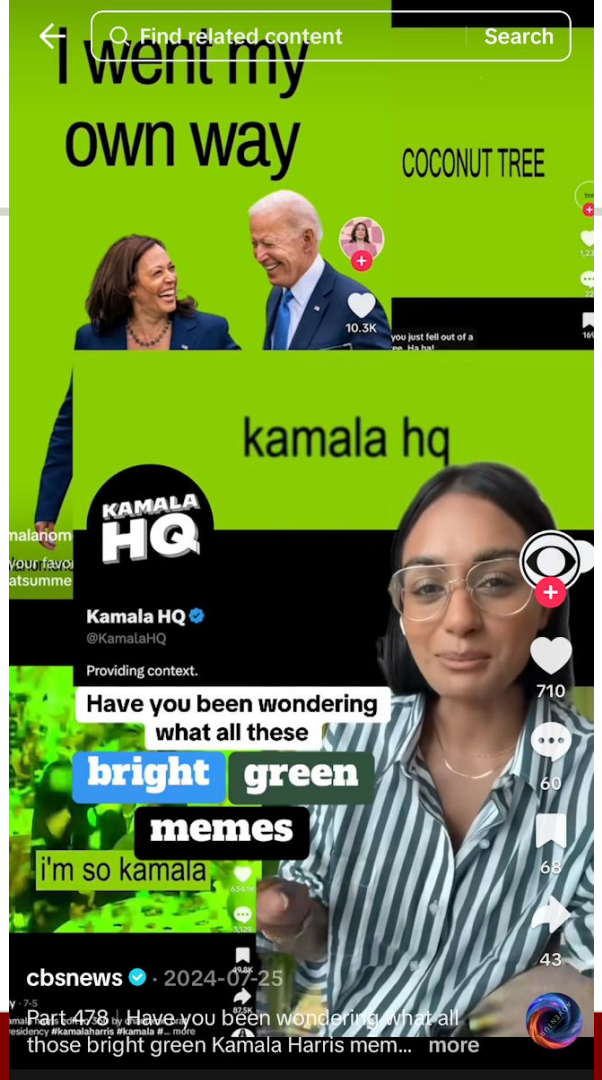
Context and Review

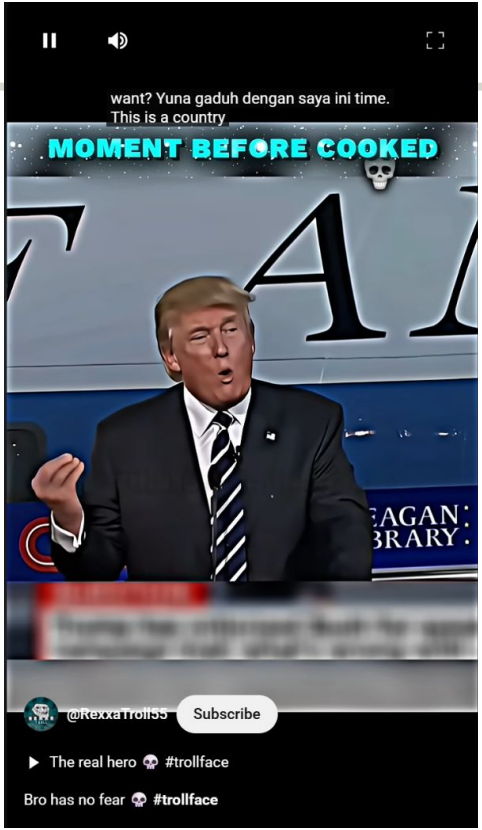


Research Question

- Main RQ: How do behaviors and interest in topics differ by partisan preference on TikTok, specifically in the case study of the American 2024 Presidential election?
  - RQ 1: Of the TikTok users who followed official TikTok campaign accounts, what are the topics of those users' reposted TikTok posts?
  - RQ 2: Of the TikTok users who followed official TikTok campaign accounts, what is the structure and overlap of the network of other accounts that users followed?

Literature Review

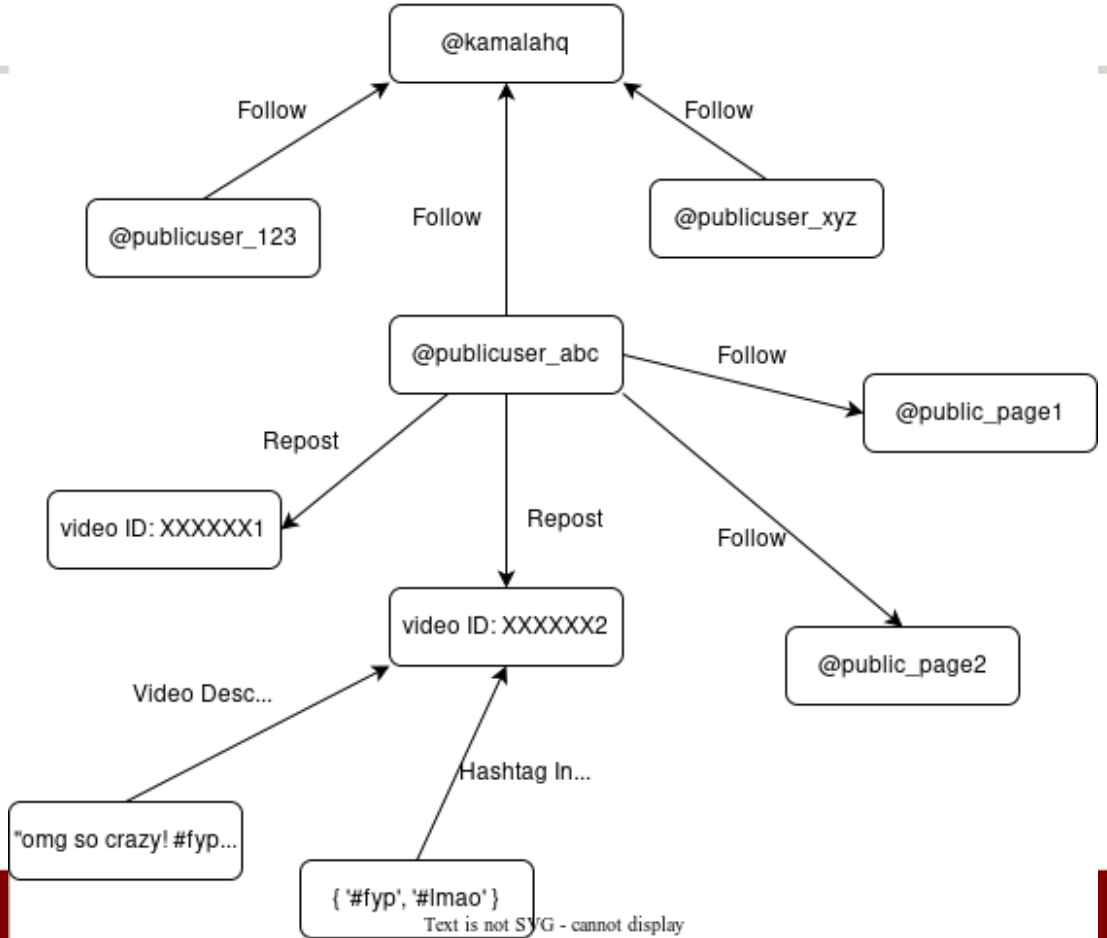
- Party preference is intertwined with our broader social life preferences
  - Party preference can be inferred from apolitical cues (Lee, 2020) (Scaduto & Negri, 2024)
  - Liberals and conservatives spend their leisure time differently (Sanaz et al., 2025)
  - Liberals and conservatives tend to show interest in different sciences (Shi et al., 2017)
- TikTok blurs the line between politics and entertainment: politainment
  - Strategy employed in elections worldwide (Cervi et al., 2023) (Zamora-Medina et al., 2023)



Data

- On or before Nov. 5, 2024
- Following network
- Repost video description/ Hashtag information

Data Structure



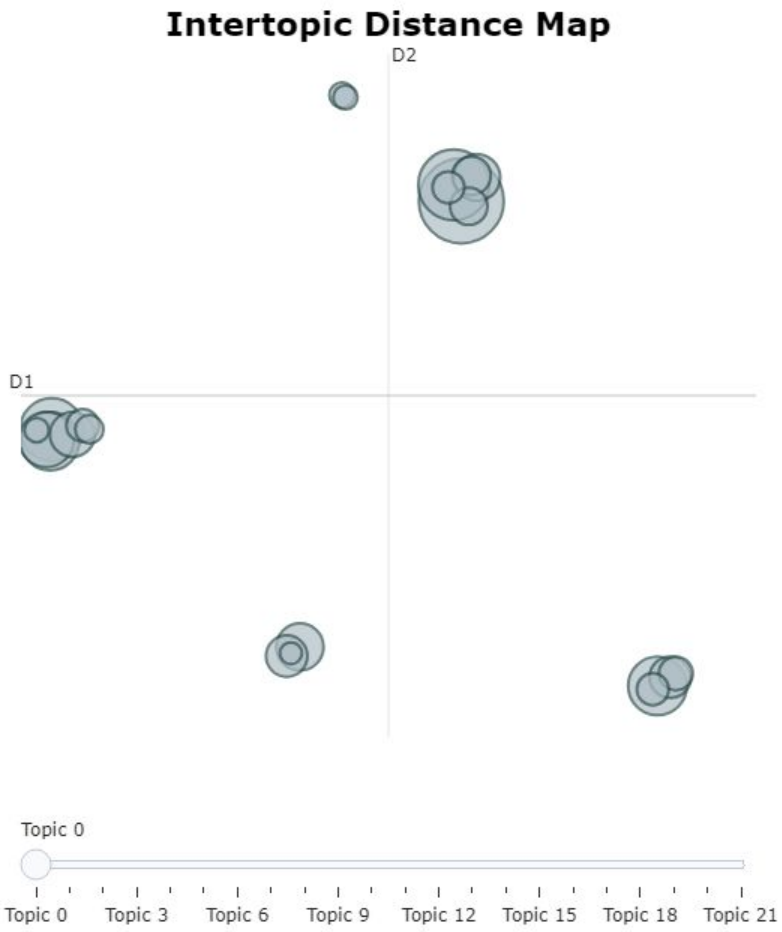
Methods

- BERTopic document clustering
- RoBERTa sentiment analysis
- Social Network Analysis

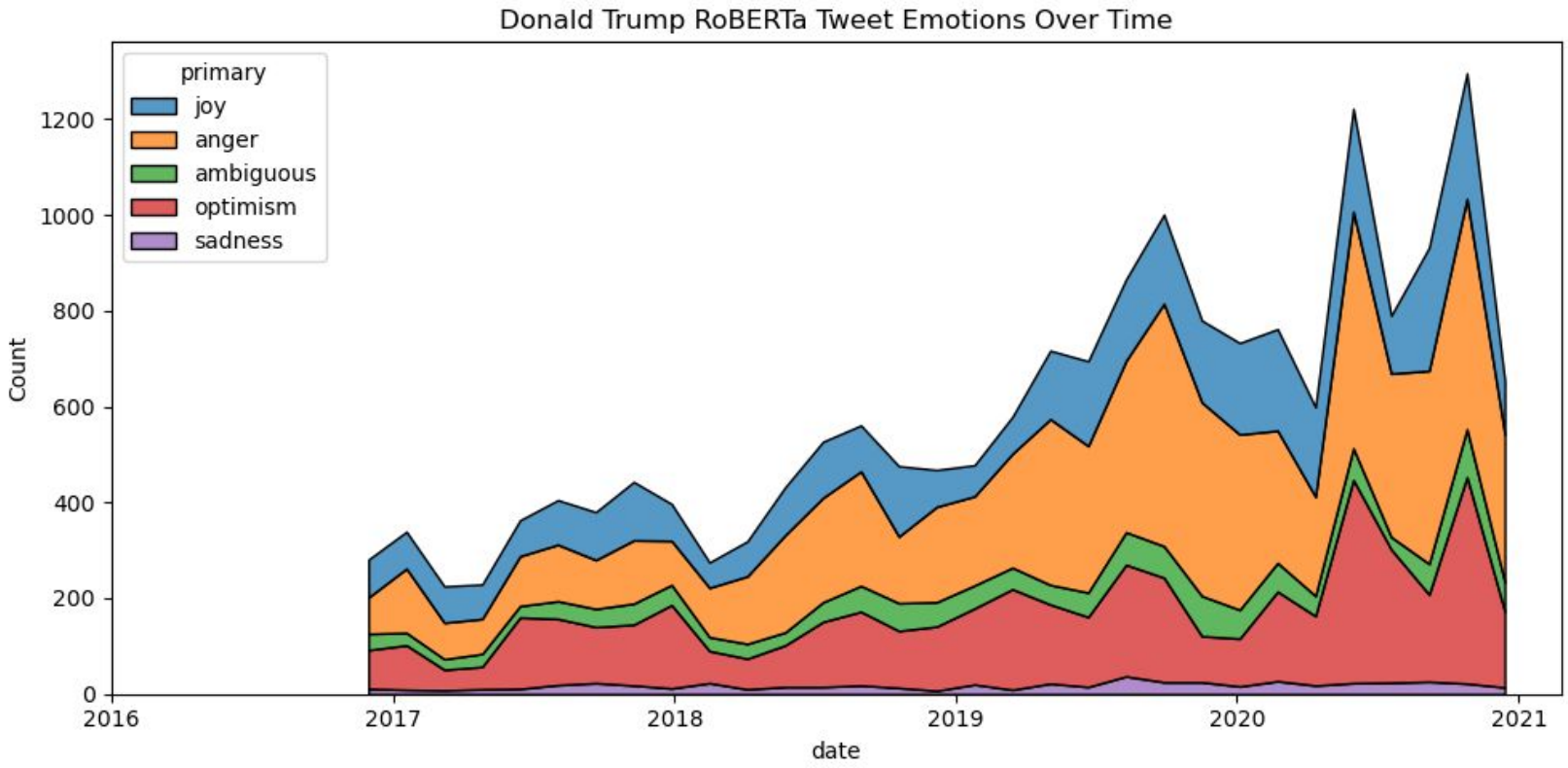

```
"data": {
    "has_more": true,
    "user_following": [
        {
            "display_name": "test user",
            "username": "test_username"
        },
        {
            "display_name": "test user 2",
            "username": "test_username2"
        },
        {
            "display_name": "test user 3",
            "username": "test_username3"
        }
    ],
    "cursor": 1650642422
```

Methods

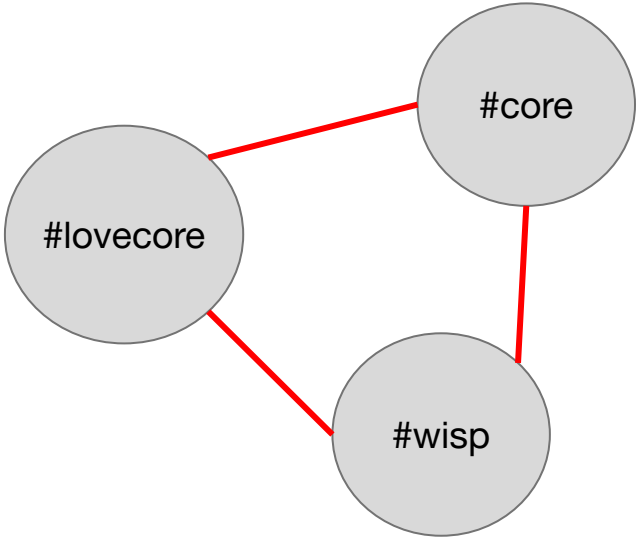

```
"videos": [
    {
        "hashtag_names": [
            "avengers",
            "pov"
        ],
        "region_code": "CA",
        "create_time": 1633823999,
        "effect_ids": [
            "0"
        ],
        "video_id": 702874395068494965,
        "music_id": 703847506349838790,
        "video_description": "lol #pov #avengers",
        "view_count": 1050,
        "comment_count": 2
    },
```

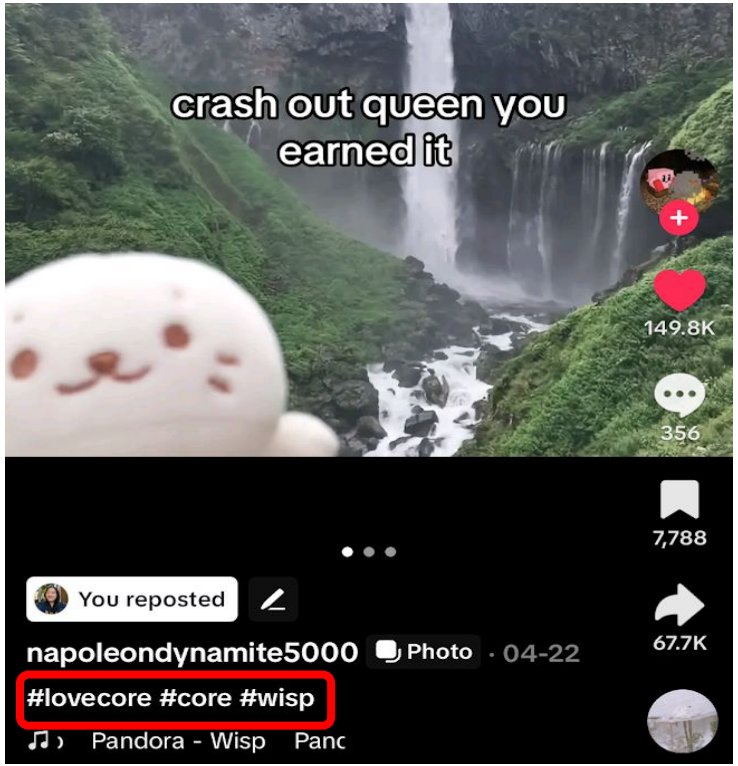



Methods

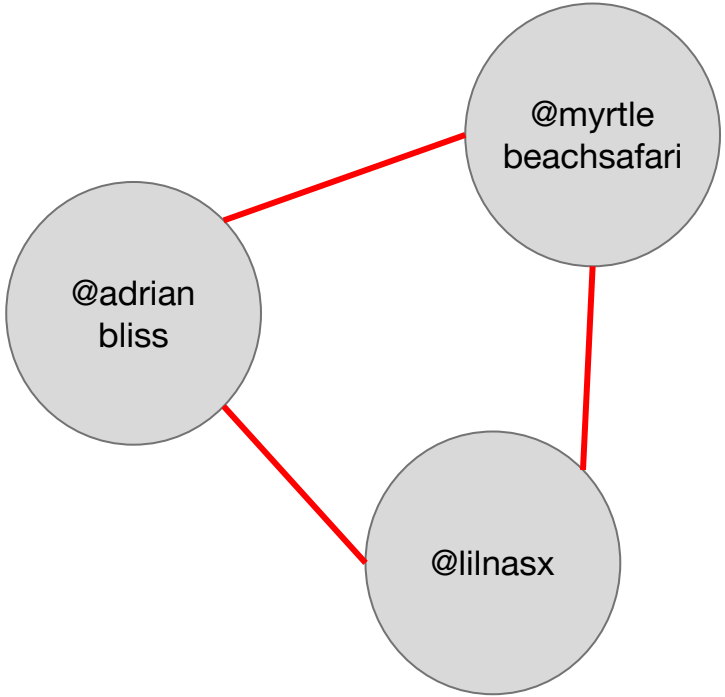

Donald Trump RoBERTa Tweet Emotions Over Time
primary
joy
anger
ambiguous
optimism
sadness
Count
0
200
400
600
800
1000
1200
2016
2017
2018
2019
2020
2021
date

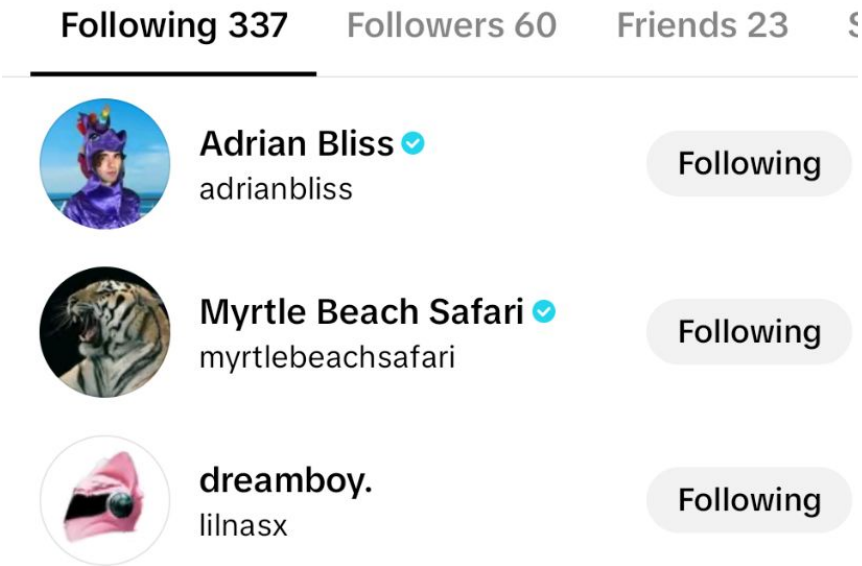
Methods


#core
#lovecore
#wisp


crash out queen you earned it
149.8K
356
7,788
You reposted
napoleondynamite5000
Photo
· 04-22
67.7K
#lovecore #core #wisp
Pandora - Wisp
Panc

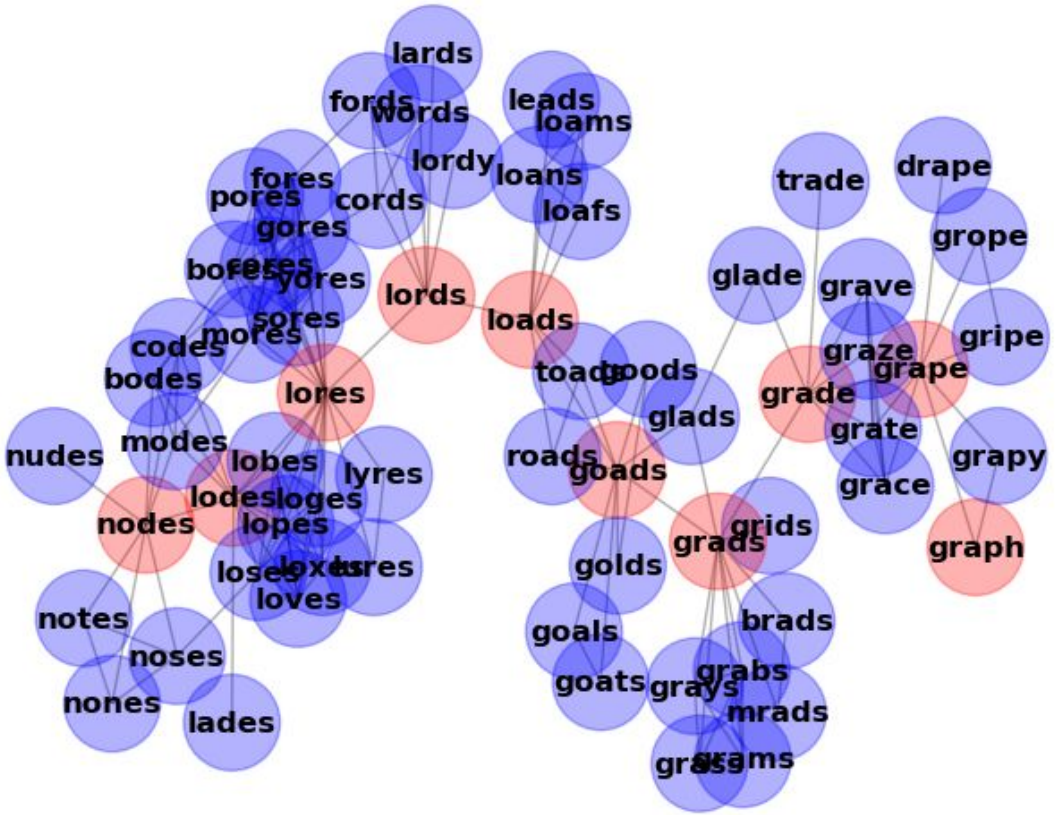
Methods


@myrtle beachsafari
@adrian bliss
@lilnasx


Following 337
Followers 60
Friends 23
Adrian Bliss
adrianbliss
Following
Myrtle Beach Safari
myrtlebeachsafari
Following
dreamboy.
lilnasx
Following

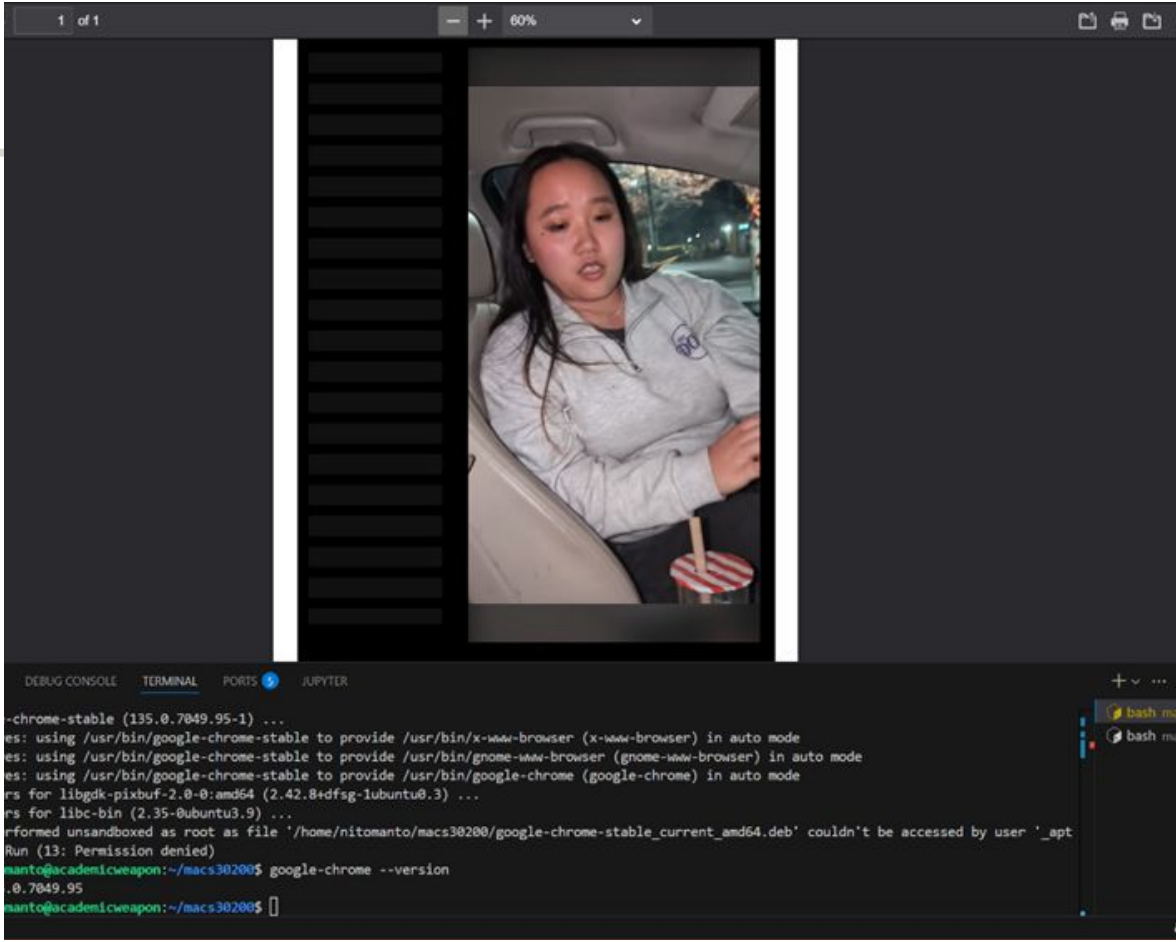
Methods

Metric	Value
Number of Nodes	5757
Number of Edges	14135
Density	0.0009
Average Degree	4.91
Minimum Degree	0
Maximum Degree	25
Average Clustering Coefficient	0.2547
Is Connected	False
Number of Connected Components	853
Diameter	N/A
Average Shortest Path Length	N/A
Degree Assortativity Coefficient	0.6495



Operationalizing

- Dynamic Scraping
- TikTok Research API Application
  - Process can take anywhere from 1-3 months
- Advisors/P.I.s
  - Fabricio Vasselai
  - Ali Sanaei
  - Zhao Wang
- Paid scraping service and Data Storage



Timeline

- Budget:
  - Data Storage (AWS Pricing) ~ $50
  - Data Scraping (Scrapfly Service Pricing) ~ $1,000 for a full dataset, $500 for a representative dataset
  - Computing (AWS Pricing) ~ $50
- Forthcoming Coursework:
  - MACS 40101 Social Network Analysis
  - MACS 40123 Large-Scale Data Mining for Social and Cultural Knowledge Discovery

GitHub